8th IEEE International Conference on Space Mission Challenges for Information Technology (SMC-IT 2021), July 26-30, 2021, Online, CubeSat Student Mini-Workshop

A multirate variational approach to simulation and optimal control for flexible spacecraft: An extension

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Prof. Sina Ober-Blöbaum §

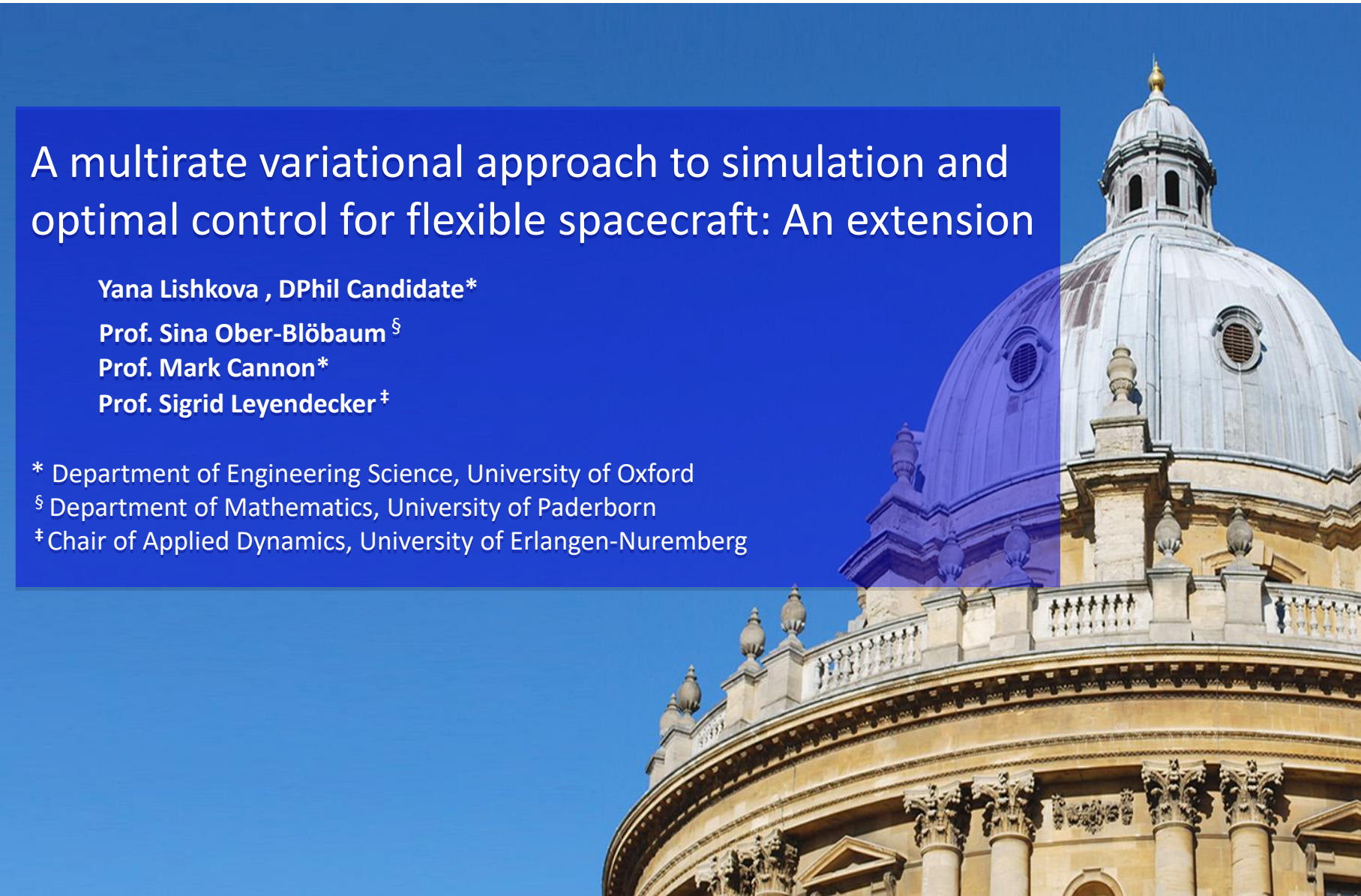
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Outline

- Short overview
- Mathematical model
- Multirate DMOC
- Computational results and discussion

Overview

- **Flexible spacecraft**
  - Stringent performance and positioning requirements
  - Efficient operation
  - **Lightweight structure designs and induced vibrations** potentially degrading the performance, causing loss of pointing accuracy or even structural damage

  -> Need for efficient control method maximizing the system's performance while respecting all hard safety-critical constraints

- **Multirate Discrete Mechanics and Optimal Control (Multirate DMOC)[1-4]:**

✓ **High fidelity simulation at a reduced computational cost**

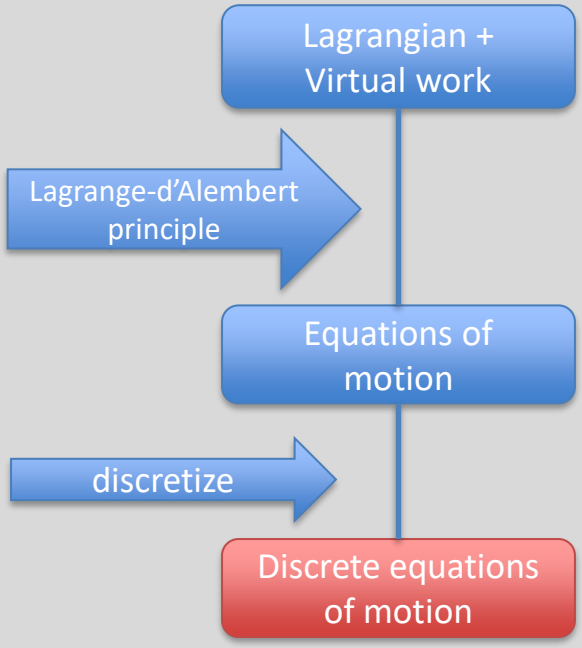
Advantages

- **Multirate Discrete Mechanics and Optimal Control (Multirate DMOC):**

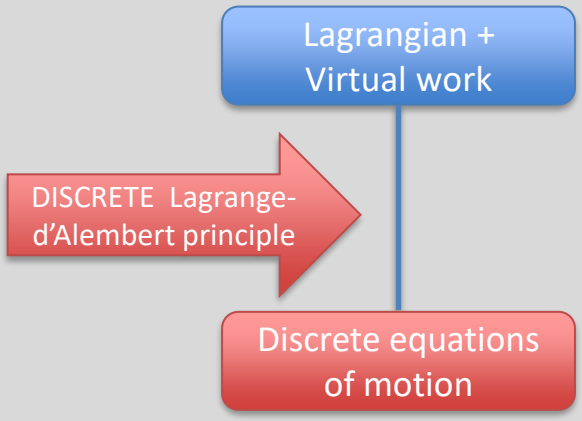
  High fidelity simulation at a reduced computational cost

  ✓ **Structure-preserving -> *conservation of energy and/or momenta of the system***

Standard direct methods



DMOC

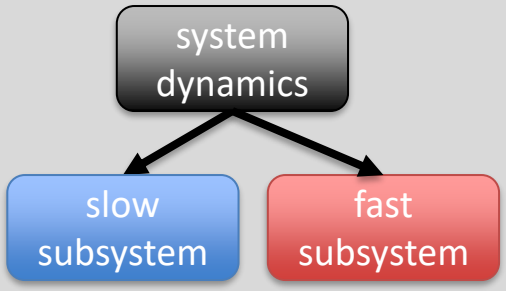


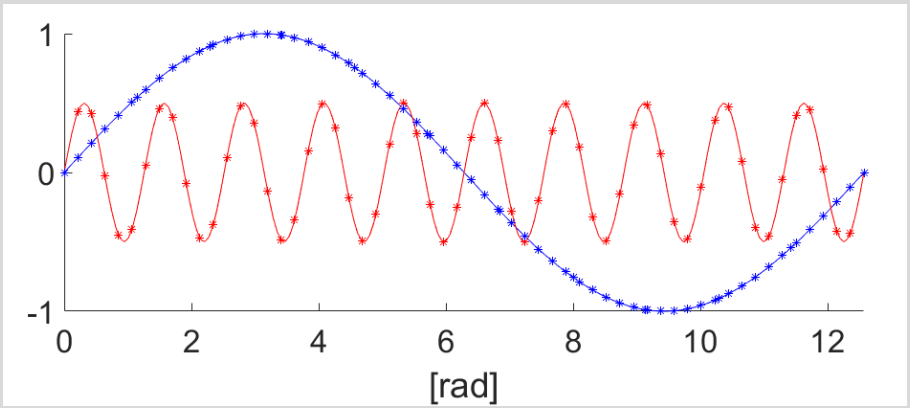
Advantages

- **Multirate Discrete Mechanics and Optimal Control (Multirate DMOC):**

  High fidelity simulation at a reduced computational cost

  - ✓ Structure-preserving -> *conservation of energy and/or momenta of the system*
  - ✓ **Multirate discretization -> *computational efficiency*** [5]



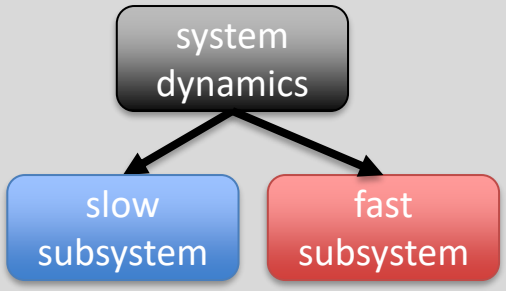


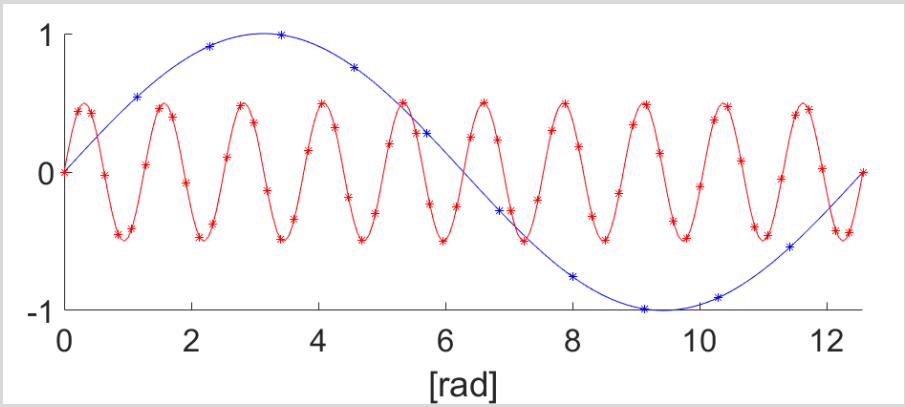
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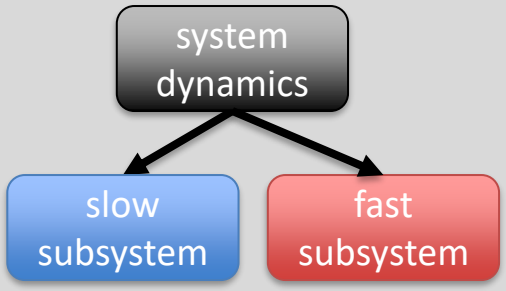
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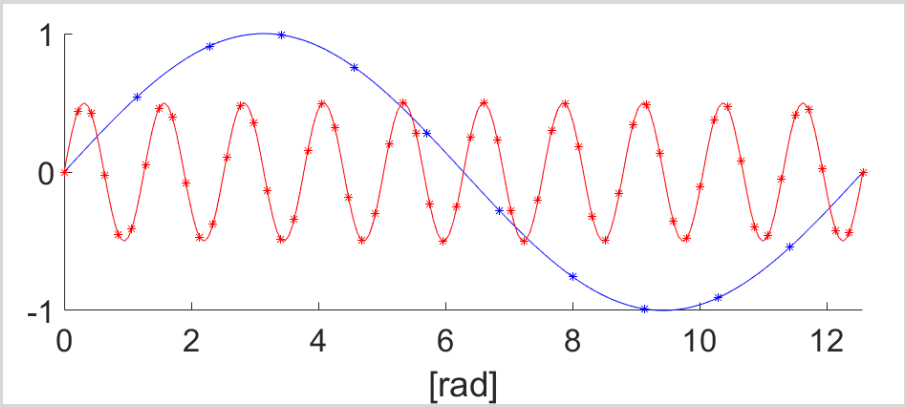
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  High fidelity simulation at a reduced computational cost

  ✓ Structure-preserving -> *conservation of energy and/or momenta of the system*

  ✓ **Multirate discretization -> *computational efficiency*** [5]





- **Reduces the number of optimization variables**
- **Reduces the number of equality constraints**

Advantages

- **Multirate Discrete Mechanics and Optimal Control (Multirate DMOC):**

  High fidelity simulation at a reduced computational cost

  - ✓ Structure-preserving -> *conservation of energy and/or momenta of the system*
  - ✓ Multirate discretization -> *computational efficiency*

    - M. Azadi, M. Eghtesad, S. Fazelzadeh, and E. Azadi, "Dynamics and control of a smart flexible satellite moving in an orbit," *Multibody System Dynamics*, Vol. 35, No. 1, 2015, pp. 1–23.

Advantages

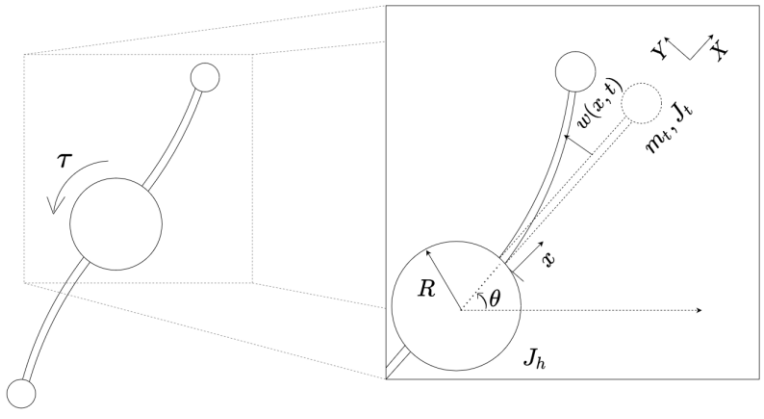
- **Multirate Discrete Mechanics and Optimal Control (Multirate DMOC):**

  High fidelity simulation at a reduced computational cost

  - ✓ Structure-preserving -> *conservation of energy and/or momenta of the system*
  - ✓ Multirate discretization -> *computational efficiency*
  - ✓ Unified control methodology -> *potential improvement in optimality and constraint-handling capabilities*
  - ✓ No need for decoupling of the equations of motion -> *simple application to a variety of linear and nonlinear models*
  - ✓ Straightforward selection of slow and fast subsystems -> *capability to tailor the solution to the time scales present in the problem to obtain further reductions in computational cost*
  - ✓ *Potential to avoid computation of the momentum -> large computational savings by further reducing the number of constraints and the unknowns by approximately a third*

Mathematical model

- **General linear model neglecting dissipation effects**
  - **single-axis rest-to-rest rotational maneuver**
  - **control torque applied at the hub**



- **Spatial discretization - The Assumed Modes Method [7]**

$$w(x,t) = \sum_{j=1}^{N} \phi_j(x)\, \eta_j(t), \qquad x \in [0, L]$$

ϕ_j - assumed spatial mode shapes
η_j - time varying modal amplitudes
N - number of modes retained in the approximation
L - length of the beam

- **System description [7]**

$$\underline{\xi} = \begin{bmatrix} \theta \\ \underline{\eta} \end{bmatrix}, \qquad \underline{\eta} = [\eta_1,\ \eta_2,\ \ldots,\ \eta_N]^T \in R^{N\times 1}$$

  - **Lagrange - d'Alembert principle**

$$\mathcal{L}(\underline{\xi},\ \dot{\underline{\xi}}) = \frac{1}{2}\,\dot{\underline{\xi}}^T\,\mathbf{M}\,\dot{\underline{\xi}} - \frac{1}{2}\,\underline{\xi}^T\,\mathbf{K}\,\underline{\xi}, \qquad \delta W = \underline{\mathrm{f}}\cdot\underline{\xi} = \tau\cdot\delta\theta - \mathbf{C}\,\dot{\underline{\xi}}\cdot\delta\underline{\xi}$$

$$\delta\int_{t_0}^{t_f}\mathcal{L}(\underline{\xi},\ \dot{\underline{\xi}})\,dt + \int_{t_0}^{t_f}(\,\underline{\mathrm{f}}\cdot\delta\underline{\xi}\,)\,dt = 0 \text{ for all variations } \delta\underline{\xi} \text{ with } \delta\underline{\xi}(t_0) = \delta\underline{\xi}(t_f) = 0$$

$$\mathbf{M}\,\ddot{\underline{\xi}} + \mathbf{C}\,\dot{\underline{\xi}} + \mathbf{K}\,\underline{\xi} = \mathbf{D}\,\tau\,, \quad \mathbf{M} = \begin{bmatrix} M_{\theta\theta} & M_{\theta\eta}^T \\ M_{\theta\eta} & M_{\eta\eta} \end{bmatrix},\ \mathbf{K} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 0 & K_{\eta\eta} \end{bmatrix},\ \mathbf{C} = \begin{bmatrix} C_{\theta\theta} & 0 \\ 0 & C_{\eta\eta} \end{bmatrix},\ \mathbf{D} = [1, 0, ..., 0]^T$$

Transformation to modal coordinates

$$\underline{\xi} = \begin{bmatrix} \theta \\ \underline{\eta} \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\mathcal{L}(\underline{\xi}, \dot{\underline{\xi}}) = \frac{1}{2}\dot{\underline{\xi}}^T \mathbf{M}\,\dot{\underline{\xi}} - \frac{1}{2}\underline{\xi}^T \mathbf{K}\,\underline{\xi}$$

$$\underline{\mathrm{f}} = \mathbf{D}\tau$$

$$\mathbf{M}\ddot{\underline{\xi}} + \mathbf{K}\underline{\xi} = \mathbf{D}\,\tau$$

transformation to modal coordinates [7]

$$\underline{\xi} = \mathbf{E}\,\underline{q}$$

$$\mathcal{L} = \frac{1}{2}(\dot{\underline{q}}^T\dot{\underline{q}} - \underline{q}^T\mathbf{\Lambda}\,\underline{q})$$

$$\underline{f} = \mathbf{E}^T\mathbf{D}\,\tau$$

$$\ddot{\underline{q}} + \mathbf{\Lambda}\,\underline{q} = \mathbf{E}^T\mathbf{D}\,\tau$$

$$\mathbf{E}^T\mathbf{M}\mathbf{E} = \mathbf{I}, \quad \mathbf{E}^T\mathbf{K}\mathbf{E} = \mathbf{\Lambda},$$

$$w_1 \leq w_2 \leq \ldots \leq w_{N+1},$$

$$\mathbf{\Lambda} = \begin{bmatrix} \omega_1^2 & \cdots & 0 \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ 0 & \cdots & \omega_{N+1}^2 \end{bmatrix}$$

Table 1: Structural parameters used for the simulations

Hub radius	R	1.0	ft
Hub rotary inertia	J_h	8.0	slug-ft^2
Tip mass	m_t	0.156941	slug
Tip mass rotary inertia	J_t	0.0018	slug-ft^2
Beam length	L	4.0	ft
Beam height	h	6.0	in.
Beam thickness	t	0.125	in.
Beam linear density	ρA	0.0271875	slug/ft
Beam elastic modulus	E	0.1584×10^{10}	lb/ft^2

Table 2: Natural frequencies

w_1	0	rad/s
w_2	6.454	rad/s
w_3	52.41	rad/s
w_4	1.607×10^2	rad/s
w_5	3.381×10^2	rad/s
w_6	5.78×10^2	rad/s

$$N = 5$$

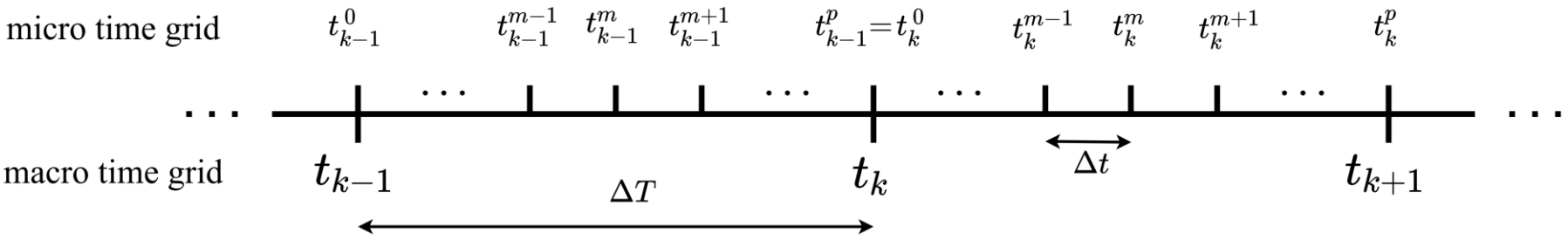
Multirate formulation

$$\underline{q} = \begin{bmatrix} q_1 \\ q_2 \\ q_3 \\ q_4 \\ q_5 \\ q_6 \end{bmatrix} \begin{matrix} \} \, \underline{q}_s \longrightarrow \begin{matrix} w_1 = 0 \text{ rad/s} \\ w_2 = 6.454 \text{ rad/s} \\ w_3 = 52.41 \text{ rad/s} \end{matrix} \\ \} \, \underline{q}_f \longrightarrow \begin{matrix} w_4 = 1.607 \times 10^2 \text{ rad/s} \\ w_5 = 3.381 \times 10^2 \text{ rad/s} \\ w_6 = 5.78 \times 10^2 \text{ rad/s} \end{matrix} \end{matrix}$$

$$\mathcal{L} = \frac{1}{2}\Big((\dot{\underline{q}}^s)^T \dot{\underline{q}}^s - (\underline{q}^s)^T \mathbf{\Lambda_s}\, \underline{q}^s \Big) + \frac{1}{2}\Big((\dot{\underline{q}}^f)^T \dot{\underline{q}}^f - (\underline{q}^f)^T \mathbf{\Lambda_f}\, \underline{q}^f \Big)$$

where $\mathbf{\Lambda_s} = \text{diag}(\omega_1^2, \ \dots \ , \omega_3^2)$, $\mathbf{\Lambda_f} = \text{diag}(\omega_4^2, \ \dots \ , \omega_6^2)$

$$p = \frac{\text{macro time step}}{\text{micro time step}} = \frac{\Delta T}{\Delta t}$$

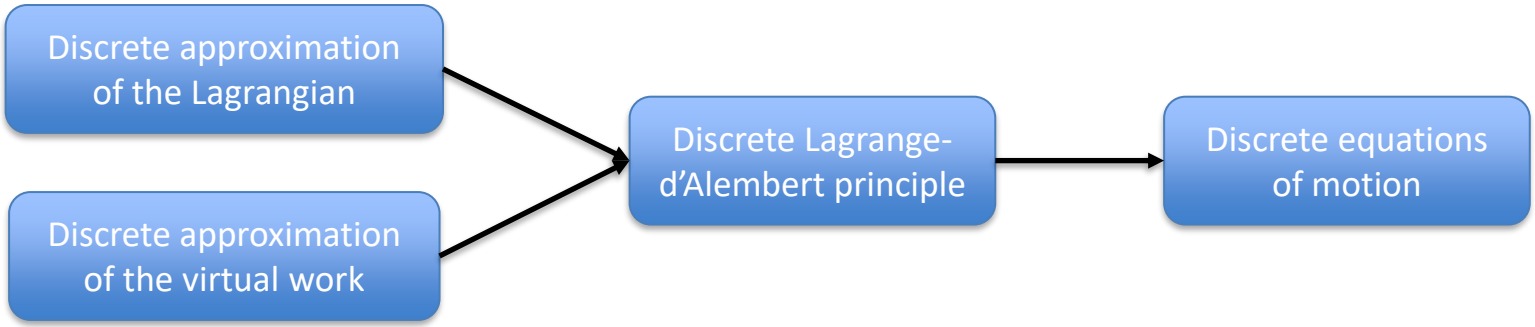


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Forward simulation without control

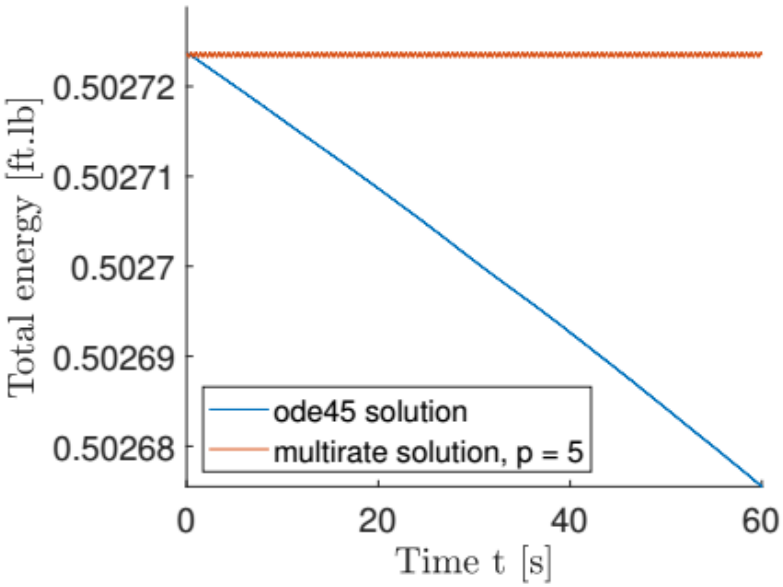


Figure 1: Numerical dissipation of total energy for simulations with $\Delta t = 10^{-4}$ and $t_f = 60$s

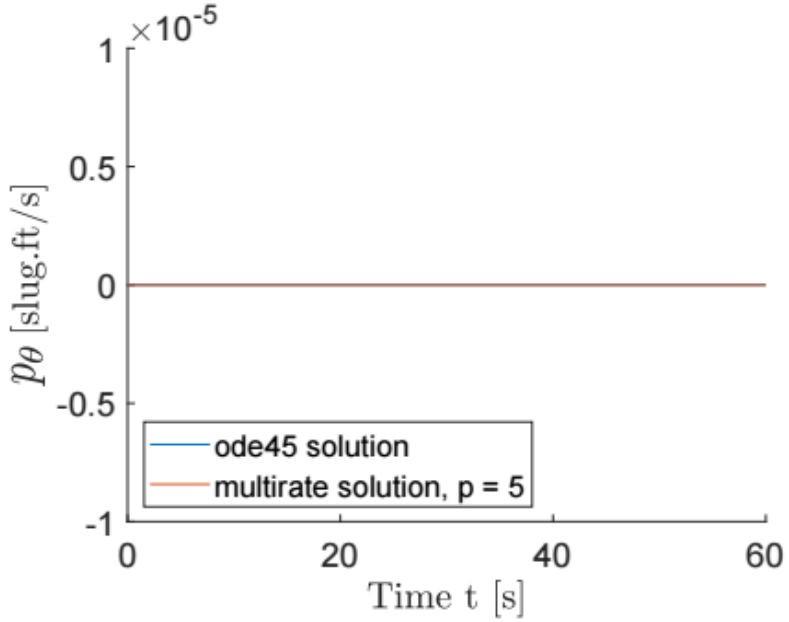


Figure 2: Momentum preservation for simulations with $\Delta t = 10^{-4}$ and $t_f = 60$s

$$p_\theta = \frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \dot{\theta}} = M_{\theta\theta}\,\dot{\theta} + (M_{\theta\eta})^T\,\underline{\dot{\eta}}$$

Optimal control problem formulation

$$J(x,u) = \int_{t_0}^{t_f} C(\underline{x}(t), u(t))\, dt = \frac{1}{2}\int_{t_0}^{t_f} [\underline{x}(t)^T \mathbf{W} \underline{x}(t) + u(t)^2]\, dt$$

$$\text{subject to} \begin{cases} \dot{\underline{x}}(t) = \mathbf{A}\underline{x}(t) + \mathbf{B}\tau(t) \\ \underline{q}(t_0) = \mathbf{E}^{-1}\underline{\xi}_{t_0}, \quad \underline{\xi}_{t_0} = [0, ..., 0]^T \\ \underline{q}(t_f) = \mathbf{E}^{-1}\underline{\xi}_{t_f}, \quad \underline{\xi}_{t_f} = [\theta_{t_f}, 0, ..., 0]^T \\ \dot{\underline{q}}(t_0) = \dot{\underline{q}}(t_f) = [0, ..., 0]^T \end{cases}$$

$$\text{where} \quad \underline{x}(t) = \begin{bmatrix} \underline{q}(t) \\ \dot{\underline{q}}(t) \end{bmatrix}, \quad u(t) = \tau(t), \quad \mathbf{A} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & \mathbf{I} \\ -\mathbf{\Lambda} & 0 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{B} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ \mathbf{E}^T\mathbf{D} \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{W} = \mathbf{I}$$

Optimal control problem formulation

$$J(x,u) = \int_{t_0}^{t_f} C(\underline{x}(t), u(t))\, dt = \frac{1}{2}\int_{t_0}^{t_f} [\underline{x}(t)^T \mathbf{W} \underline{x}(t) + u(t)^2]\, dt$$

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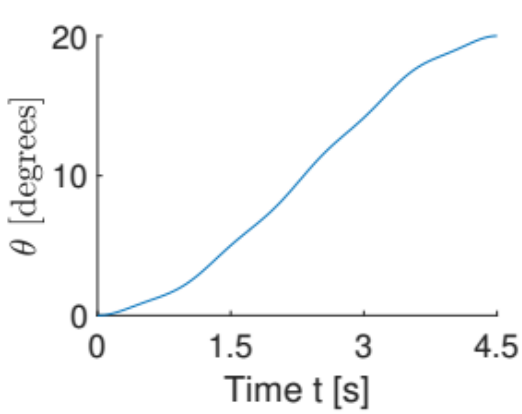
In this example the Legendre transform takes the following simple form:

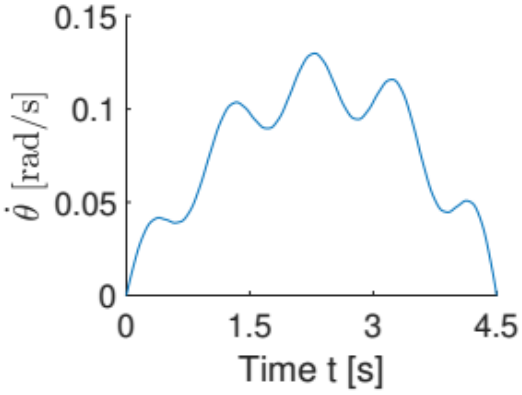
$$\underline{p} = \frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \dot{\underline{\xi}}} = \mathbf{M}\,\dot{\underline{\xi}}$$

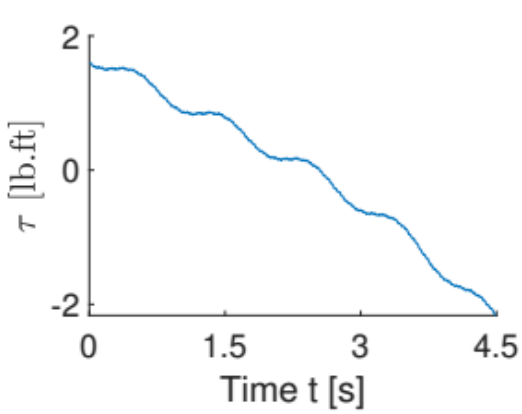
transformation to modal coordinates [7]

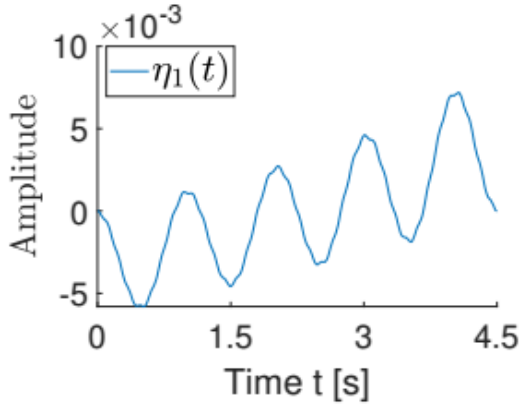
$$\underline{\mathfrak{p}} = \frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \dot{\underline{q}}} = \dot{\underline{q}}$$

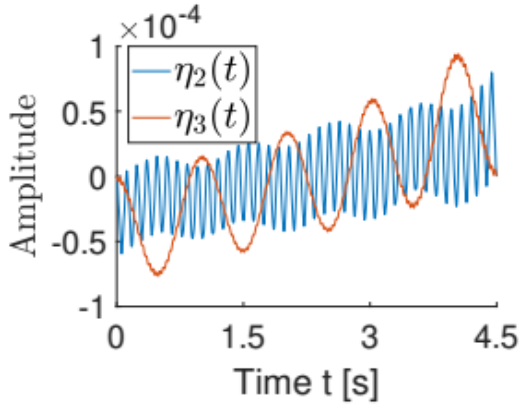
Example solution with phase space formulation











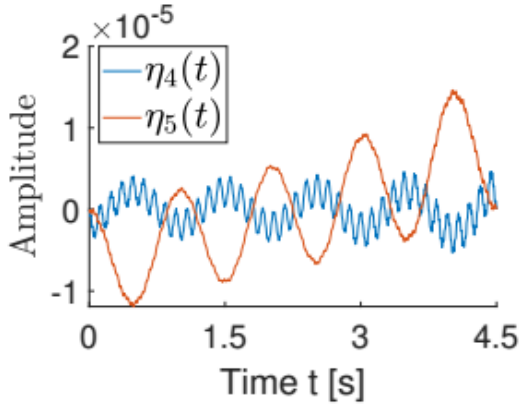
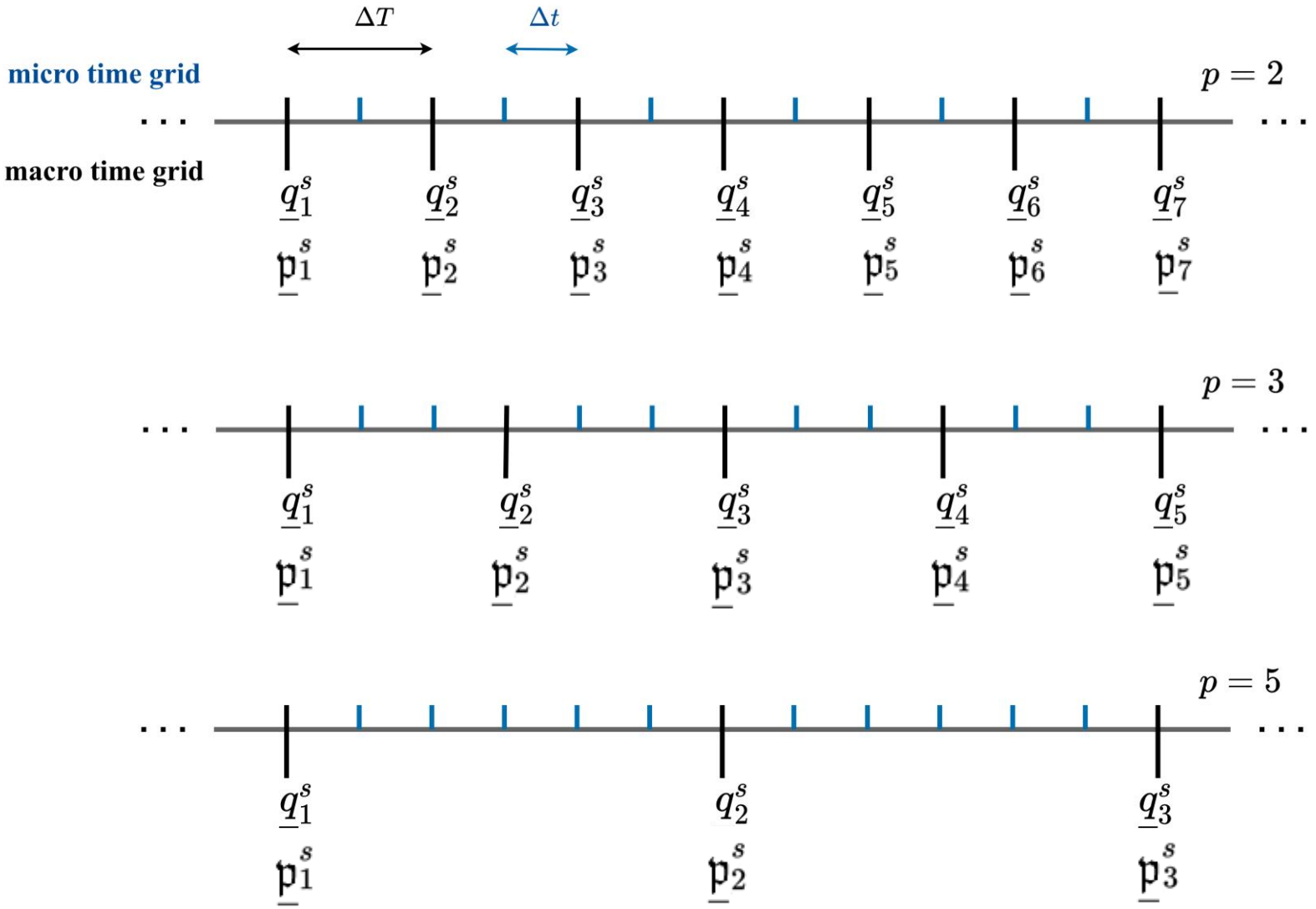


Figure 3: OCP solution with Multirate DMOC for $\theta_{t_f} = 20°$, $t_f = 4.5s$, $\Delta t = 10^{-3}$ and $p = 5$

Problem size

$$\underline{x} = \begin{bmatrix} \underline{q} \\ \underline{\mathfrak{p}} \end{bmatrix} \qquad \underline{\mathfrak{p}} = \frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \underline{\dot{q}}} \qquad p = \frac{\text{macro time step}}{\text{micro time step}} = \frac{\Delta T}{\Delta t}$$



Problem size

$n_{eq\,con}$ - number of equality constraints

$n_{slow\,var}$ - number of optimization variables resulting from discretization on the macro grid

$n_{fast\,var}$ - number of optimization variables resulting from discretization on the micro grid

$n_{total\,var} = n_{slow\,var} + n_{fast\,var}$

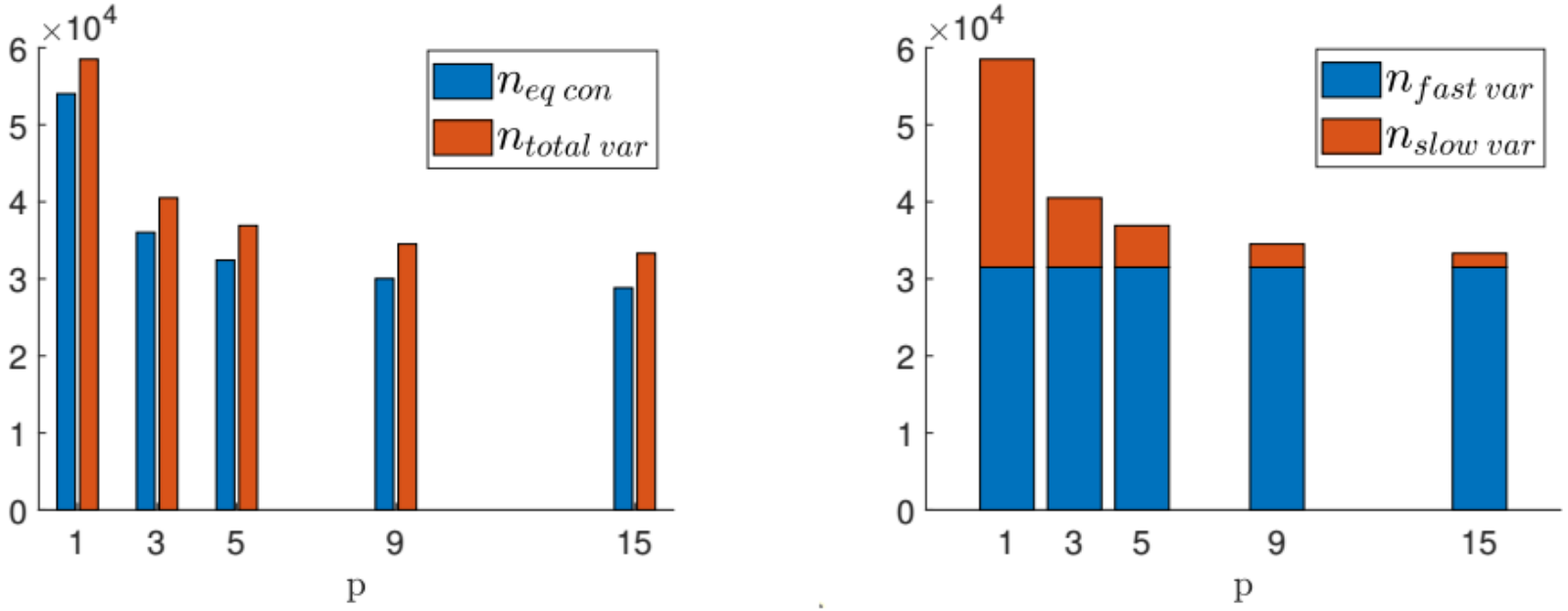


Figure 4: Size of OCP based on Multirate DMOC for a simulations with $\Delta t = 10^{-3}$ and $t_f = 4.5s$

Main result- the trade-off

$$e^{rel}_{\underline{\xi}}(\underline{\xi}_d, \underline{\xi}) = \frac{\max_{k=0,\dots,n_s}(\|\underline{\xi}_k - \underline{\xi}(t_k)\|_\infty)}{\max_{k=0,\dots,n_s}(\|\underline{\xi}(t_k)\|_\infty)}$$

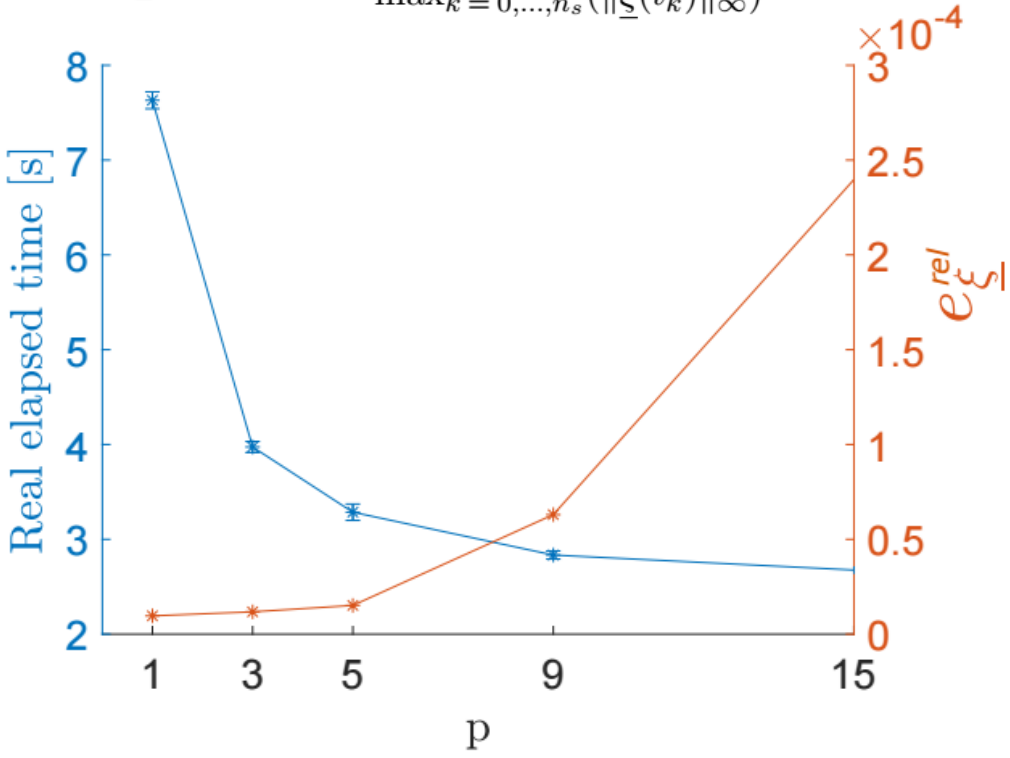


Figure 5: Mean computational time with standard deviation and relative error in $\underline{\xi}$ versus p for a constant micro time step of 10^{-3}, $t_f = 4.5s$ and $\theta_{t_f} = 20°$

Main result- the trade-off

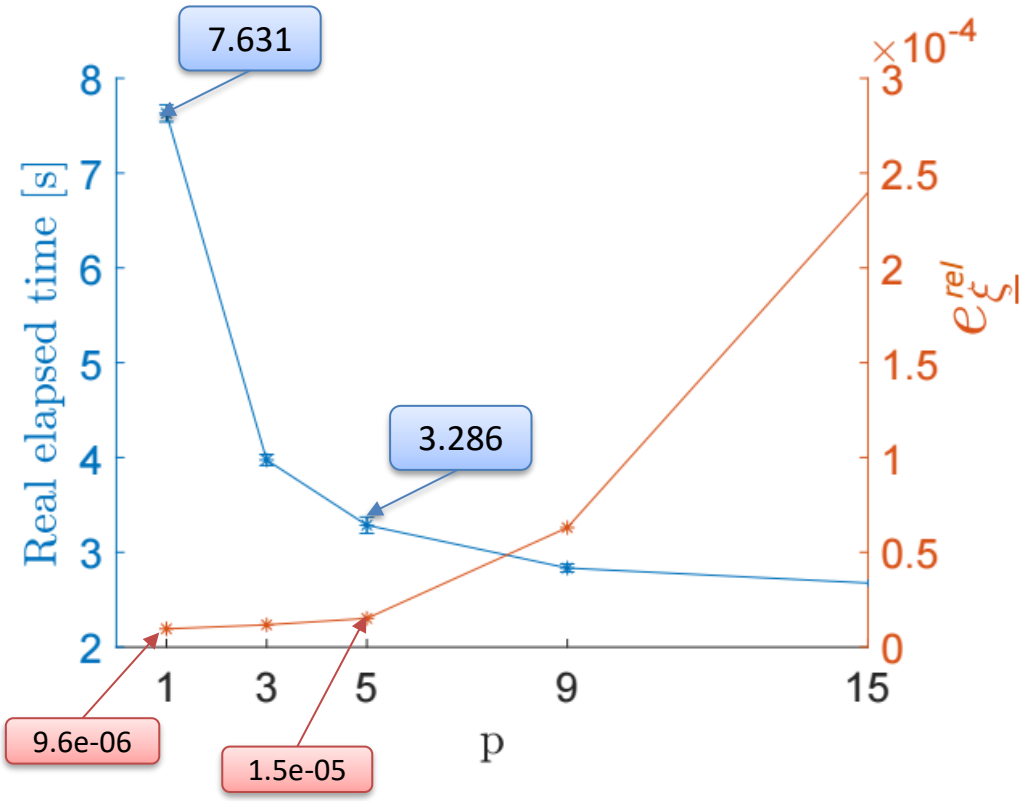


Figure 5: Mean computational time with standard deviation and relative error in $\underline{\xi}$ versus p for a constant micro time step of 10^{-3}, $t_f = 4.5s$ and $\theta_{t_f} = 20°$

Further customization

$\underline{q}^s \in R^{r\times 1}$ r - degrees of freedom of the slow subsystem

$\underline{q}^f \in R^{(N+1-r)\times 1}$ so far in the examples $r = 3,\ N = 5$

$$n_{total\ var} = n_{slow\ var} + n_{fast\ var}$$

$$n_{slow\ var}(p, r, N, t_f, \Delta t) = 2\,r\left(\frac{t_f}{p\,\Delta t} + 1\right)$$

$$n_{fast\ var}(r, N, t_f, \Delta t) = 2\,(N + 1 - r)\left(\frac{t_f}{\Delta t} + 1\right) + \frac{t_f}{\Delta t}$$

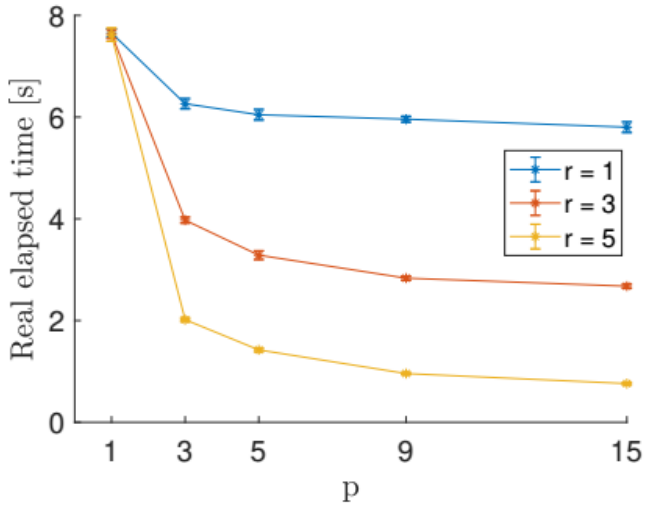


Figure 6: Mean computational time with standard deviation versus p for a constant micro time step of 10^{-3}, $t_f = 4.5s$ and $\theta_{t_f} = 20°$

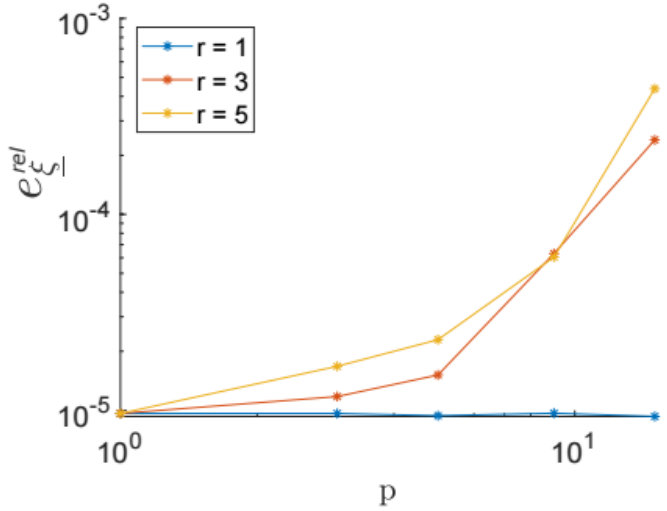


Figure 7: Relative error in $\underline{\xi}$ versus p for a constant micro time step of 10^{-3}, $t_f = 4.5s$ and $\theta_{t_f} = 20°$

The extension

The work so far has been published in the following paper:

> **Y. Lishkova, S. Ober-Blöbaum, M. Cannon, and S. Leyendecker, "**A multirate variational approach to simulation and optimal control for flexible spacecraft", *accepted for publication in Proceedings of AAS/AIAA Astrodynamics Specialist Conference, 2020*

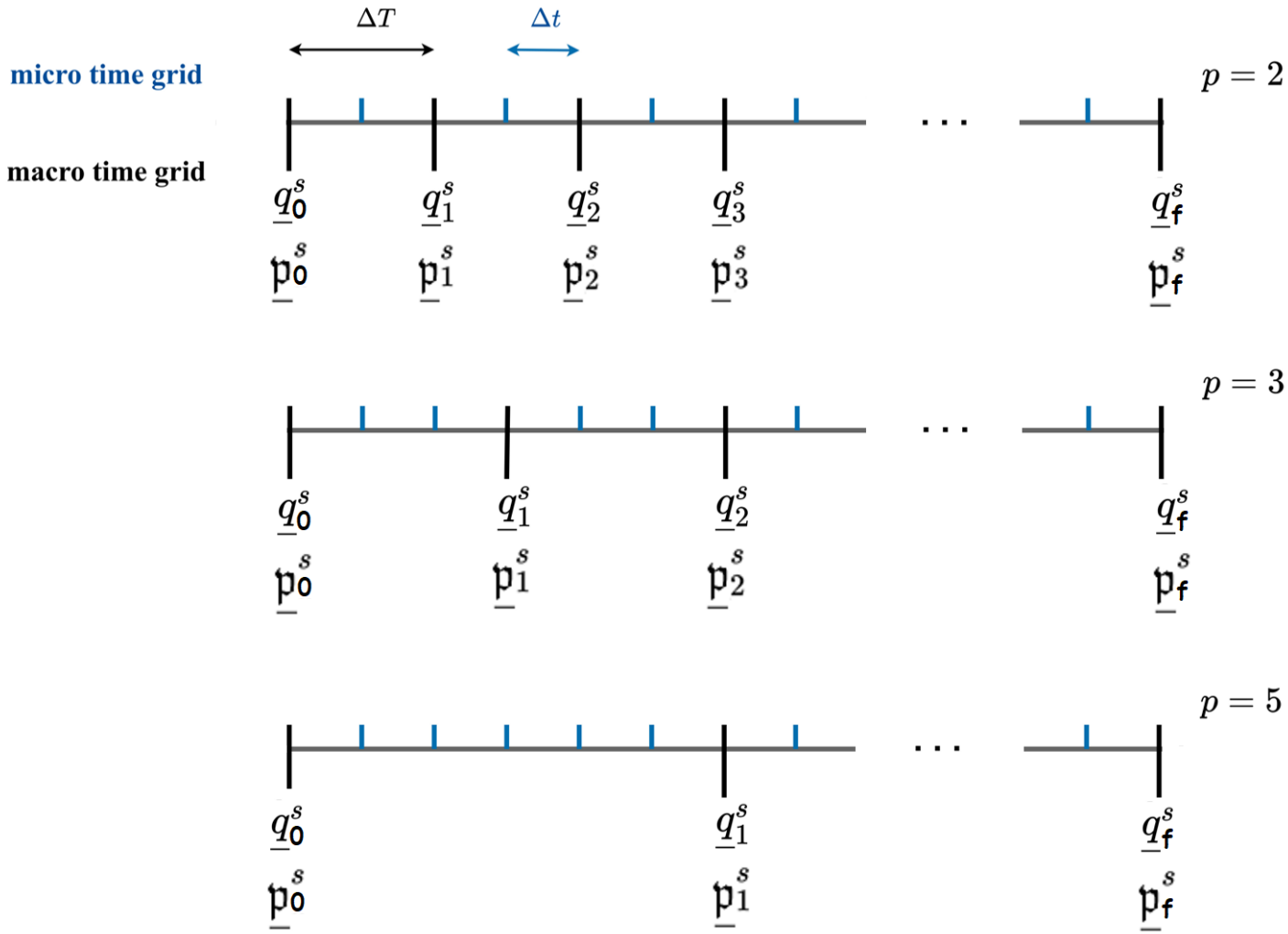
Since this work was completed, we continued to explore other formulations of the MDMOC which are capable of even further great computational savings.

- with DMOC one can formulate the optimal control problem to avoid computation of the momentum/velocity explicitly while maintaining the conservational properties of the representation
- compared to standard techniques this further reduces the size of the problem by approximately a third!

Problem size

$$\underline{\mathfrak{p}} = \frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \underline{\dot{q}}}$$

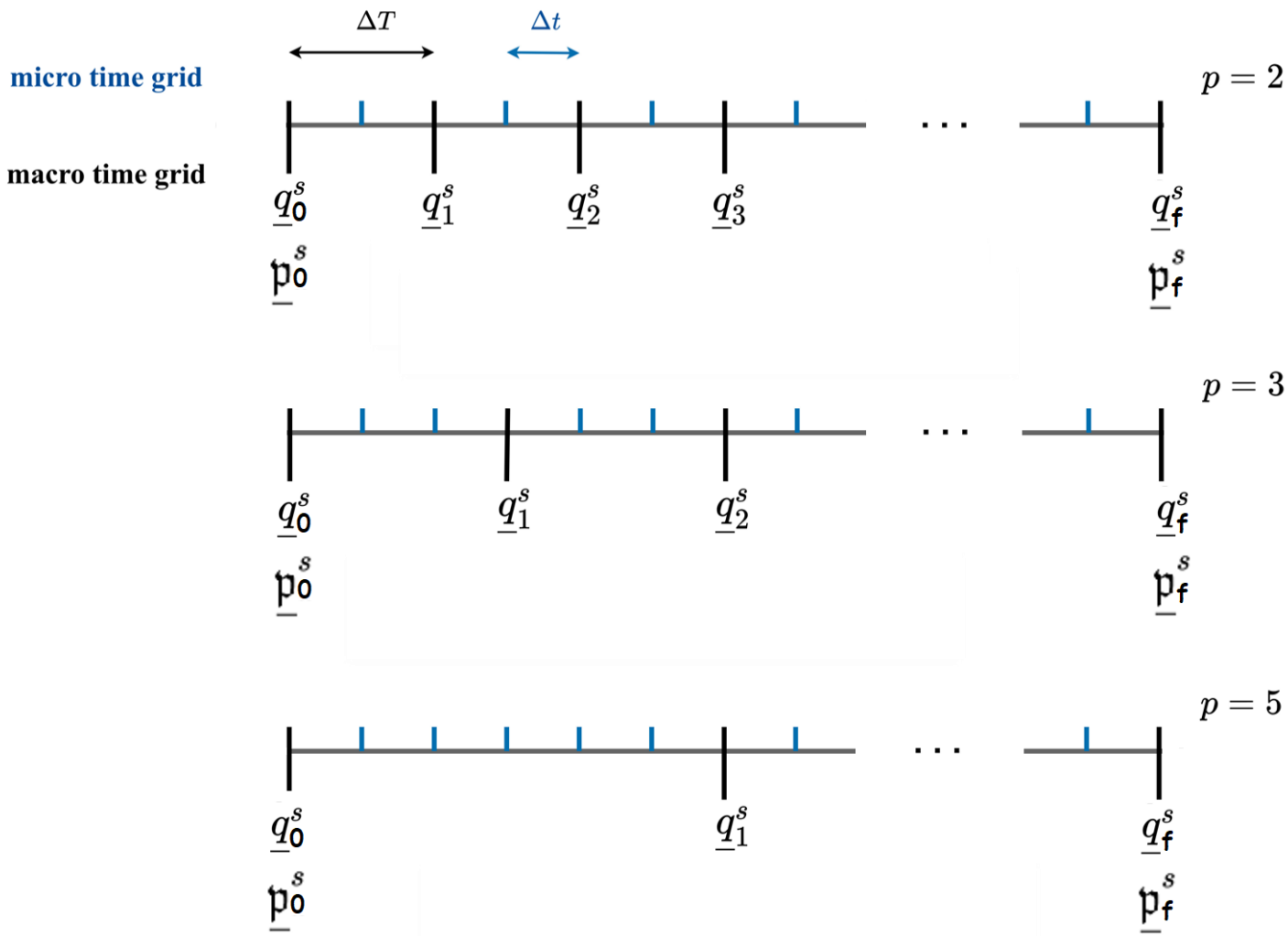
$$p = \frac{\text{macro time step}}{\text{micro time step}} = \frac{\Delta T}{\Delta t}$$



Problem size

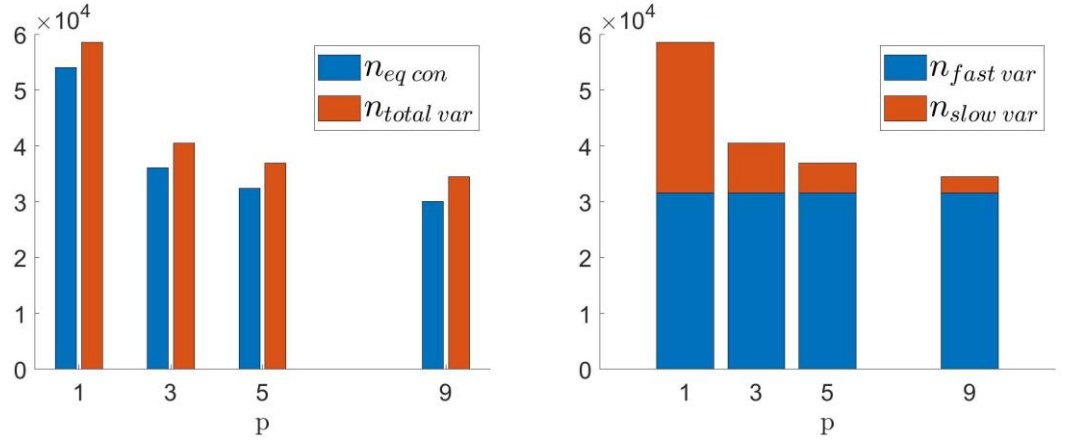
$$\underline{\mathfrak{p}} = \frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \underline{\dot{q}}}$$

$$p = \frac{\text{macro time step}}{\text{micro time step}} = \frac{\Delta T}{\Delta t}$$



Problem size: revisited

Formulation with momentum computation



Formulation without momentum computation

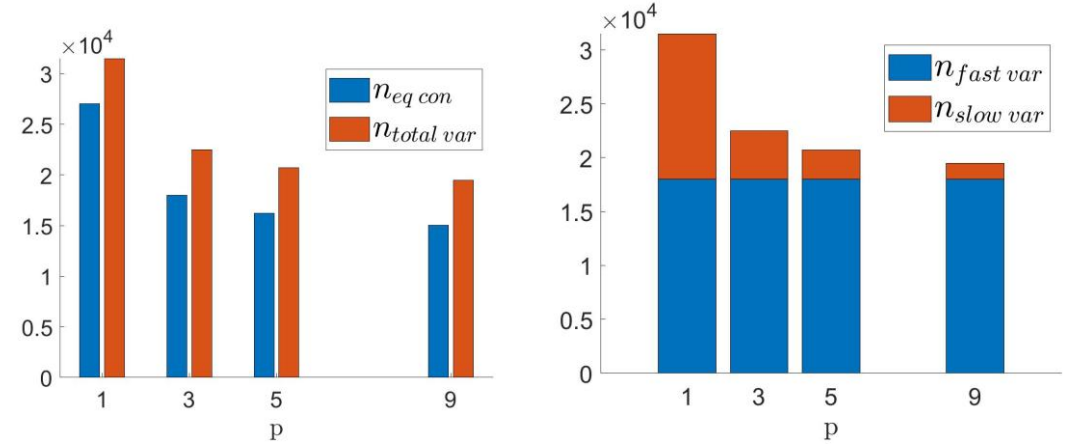
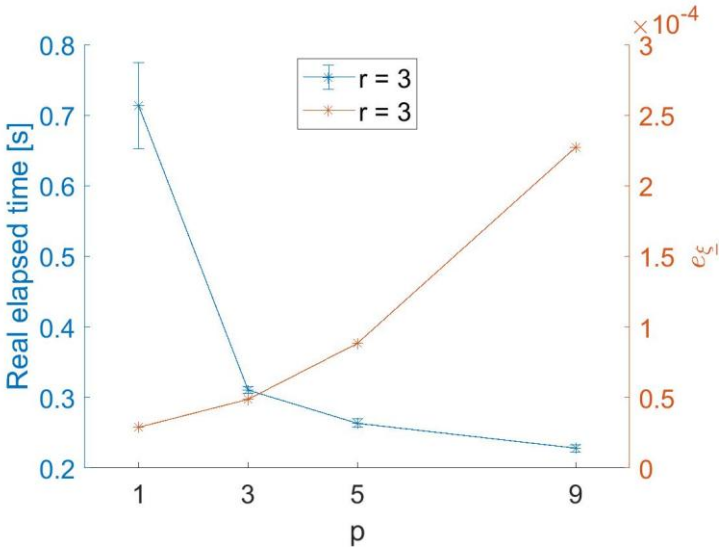


Figure 7: Size of the OCP based on the two formulations of Multirate DMOC with $\Delta t = 10^{-4}$, $t_f = 0.45s$ and no cost penalty for the momentum $\left(\mathbf{W} = \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{I} & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}\right)$

Main result- the trade-off: revisited

Formulation with momentum computation



Formulation without momentum computation

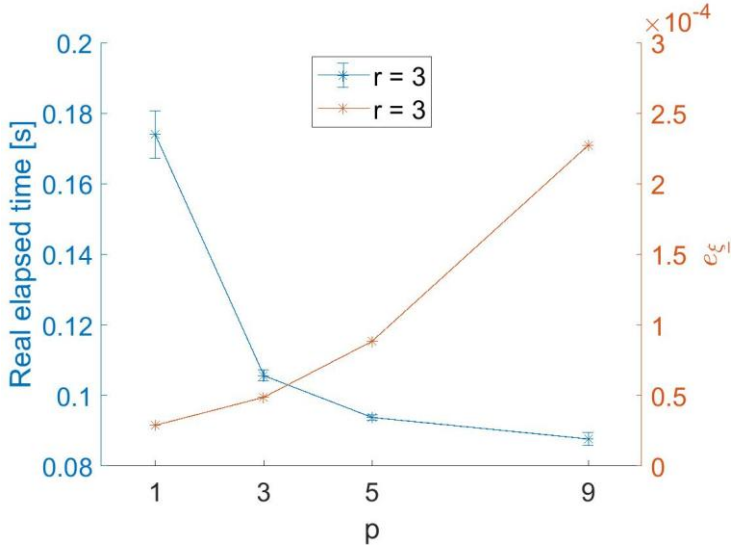


Figure 8: Mean computational time with standard deviation and relative error in ξ versus p for constant micro time step $\Delta t = 10^{-4}$, $t_f = 0.45s$ and no cost penalty for the momentum $\left(\mathbf{W} = \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{I} & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \right)$

Conclusions

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- **Multirate Discrete Mechanics and Optimal Control (Multirate DMOC):**

  High fidelity simulation at a reduced computational cost

  - ✓ Structure-preserving -> *conservation of energy and/or momenta of the system*
  - ✓ Multirate discretization -> *computational efficiency*
  - ✓ Unified control methodology -> *potential improvement in optimality and constraint- handling capabilities*
  - ✓ No need for decoupling of the equations of motion -> *simple application to a variety of linear and nonlinear models*
  - ✓ Straightforward selection of slow and fast subsystems -> *capability to tailor the solution to the time scales of the dynamics in question to obtain further reductions in computational cost*
  - ✓ *Potential to avoid computation of the momentum -> large computational savings by further reducing the number of constraints and the unknowns by approximately a third*

  Flexibility to tailor the method to the time scales of the problem and obtain the required fidelity at a reduced computational cost!

- **Future work –** methods for obtaining optimal p and r and extending the work to models including kinematic nonlinearities

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THANK YOU FOR YOUR ATTENTION!

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Original Paper:

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Main references:

[1] T. Gail, S. Ober-Blöbaum, and S. Leyendecker, "Variational multirate integration in discrete mechanics and optimal control," *Proceedings of* ECCOMAS, 2017, pp. 1–4.

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